income. However, their familial and emotional connections last for many decades after they have immigrated. Many of these people send part of their income as remittances for family and relations. Globally, Indians settled abroad as non-residents transferred as much as $75.7 billion in 2019–20, which added to the national income of India. As immigrant labour earns income by and large by delivering services, this income is another variant of the export of services.

If we take a wider view of the services exported from India, we can add incomes earned by export of services ($213.2 billion), incomes earned as compensation by Indian resident employees ($5.6 billion) and remittances made by the Indian diaspora ($75.7 billion) as services. Together, India earned $294.5 billion from these different modes of export of services. The country's total current account income was $642.1 billion ($533.6 billion of goods and services, $25.2 billion of primary income of factors of production and $83.4 billion of secondary income, mainly remittances). The income earned by services was virtually half (45.9 per cent) of the total income in 2019–20 from the rest of the world.

The day when services will contribute about half the total income of Indian residents from abroad does not appear to be far away. The day when export of services exceeds the export of goods will also occur in the not-so-distant future if we plan and focus on our services export strategy better.

Growing Share in Services Export but Presence in Only a Narrow Range of Services

The export of services takes place, as agreed by the global community in the General Agreement on Trade in Services, in four modes: cross-border supply (services flow from one country to another, mostly electronically); consumption abroad (the customer physically travels to the country of the service provider, such as a tourist for pleasure or medical treatment); commercial presence (by establishing a business establishment in the